Understanding Cervical Cancer Screening Patterns in Women

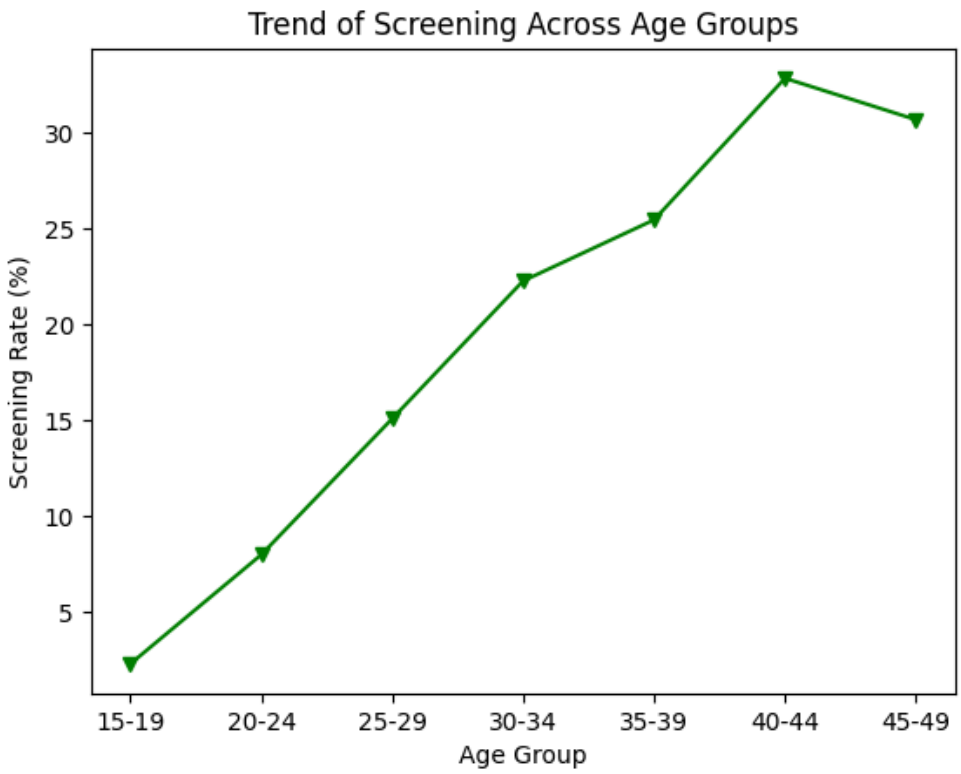
Who is getting screened, and who is being left behind?

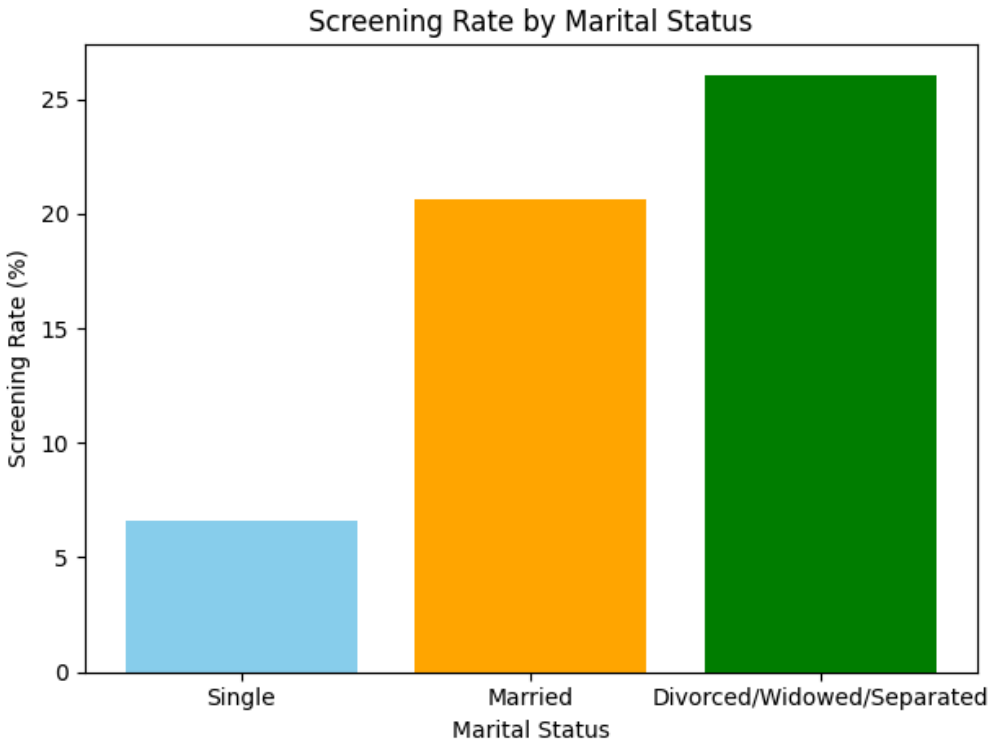
Cervical cancer remains one of the leading causes of cancer-related deaths among women, particularly in low- and middle-income countries like Kenya, where access to preventive services is still limited. Despite being largely preventable through early screening and treatment of precancerous lesions, screening uptake remains very low, with only a small proportion of women ever being screened.

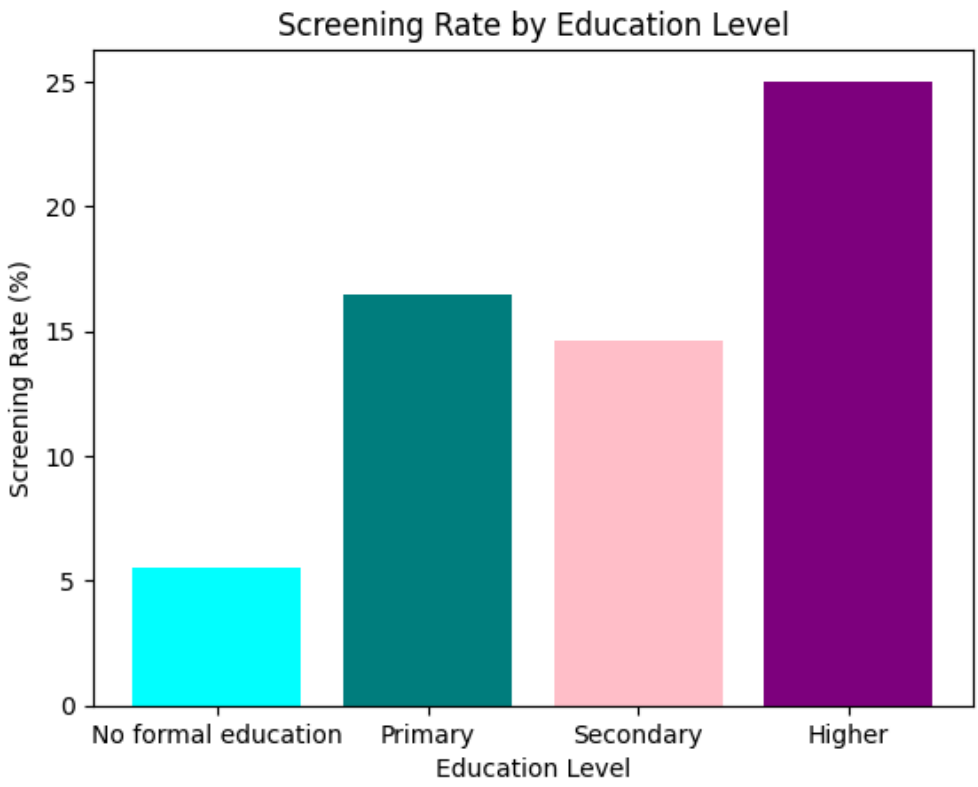
Average prevalence **(12.50%)**

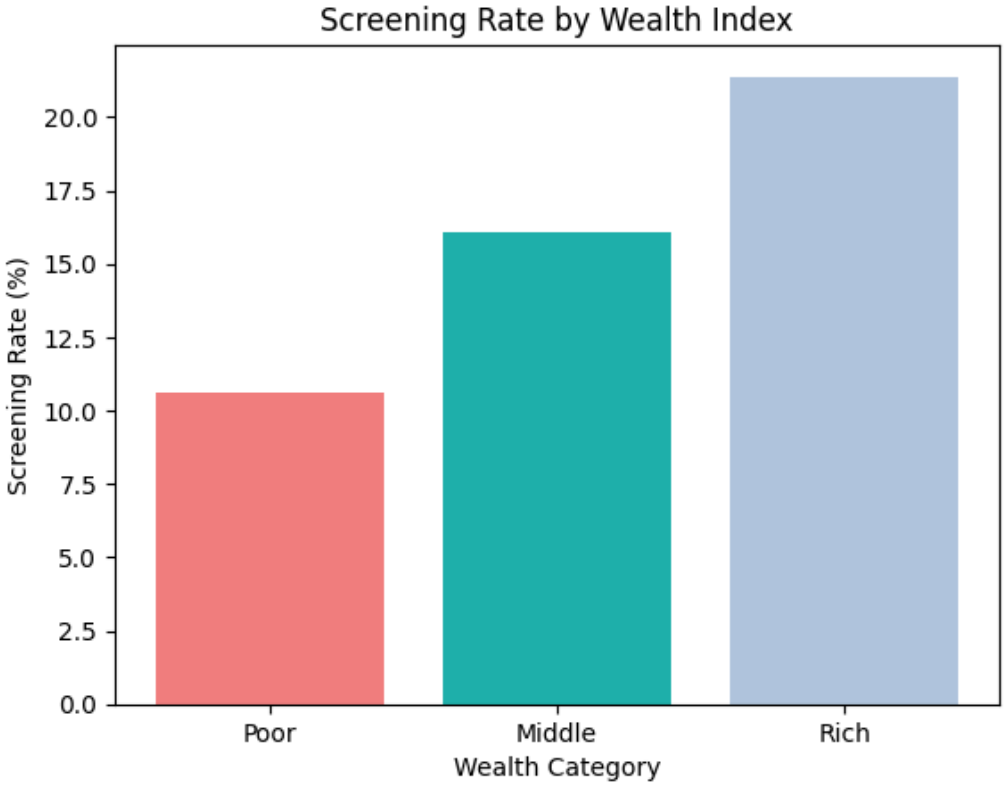
This analysis is important because it helps identify the key social, economic, and access-related factors that influence whether women get screened. Understanding these patterns can guide targeted interventions, such as community outreach, improved access to services, and awareness campaigns in order to increase screening rates and ultimately reduce preventable deaths.

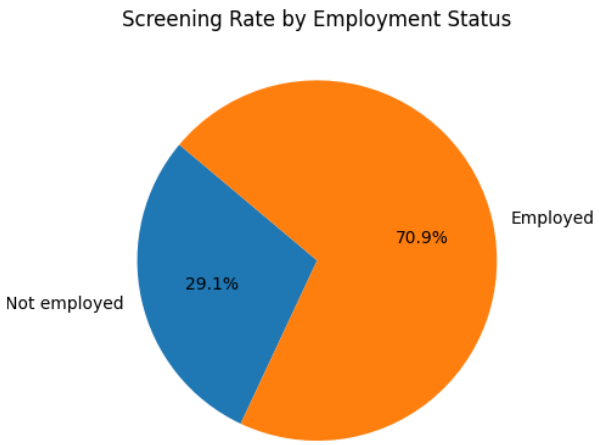
This will demonstrate the key sociodemographic factors that drive screening across various geographic locations, age, gender, education, wealth and employment status.

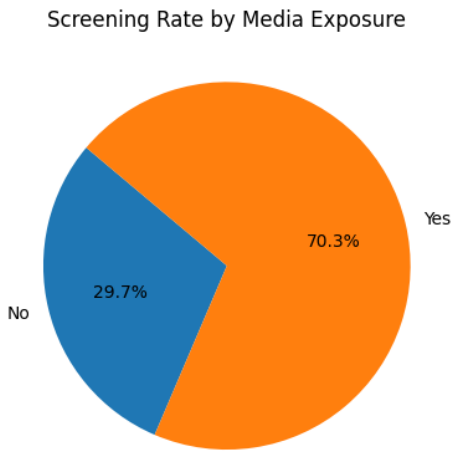

Trend of Screening Across Age Groups
Screening Rate (%)
30
25
20
15
10
5
15-19
20-24
25-29
30-34
35-39
40-44
45-49
Age Group

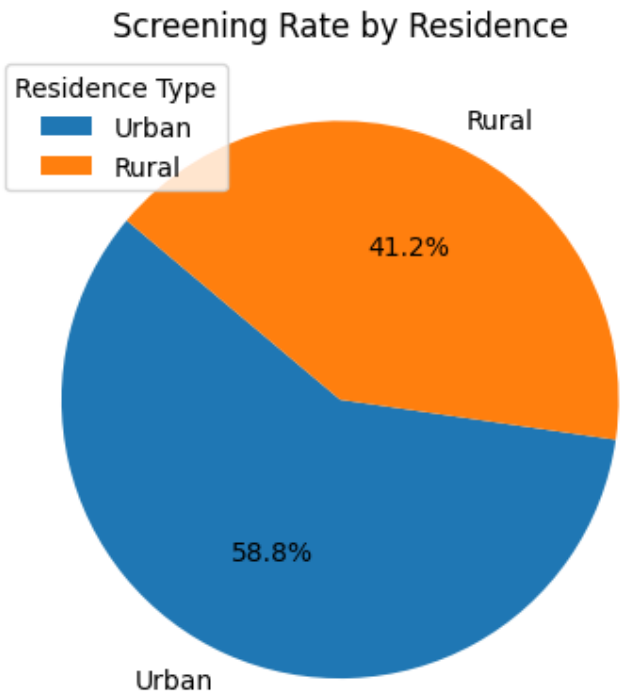

Screening Rate by Marital Status
Screening Rate (%)
25
20
15
10
5
0
Single
Married
Divorced/Widowed/Separated
Marital Status

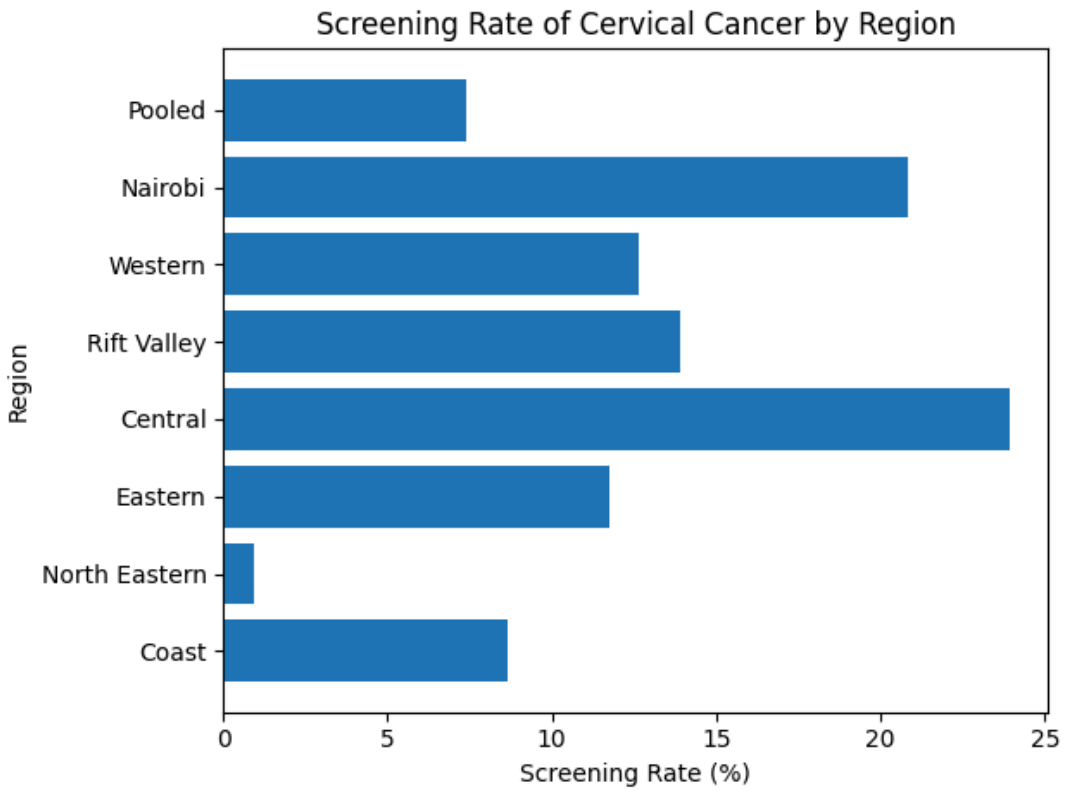

Screening Rate by Education Level
Screening Rate (%)
0
5
10
15
20
25
No formal education
Primary
Secondary
Higher
Education Level

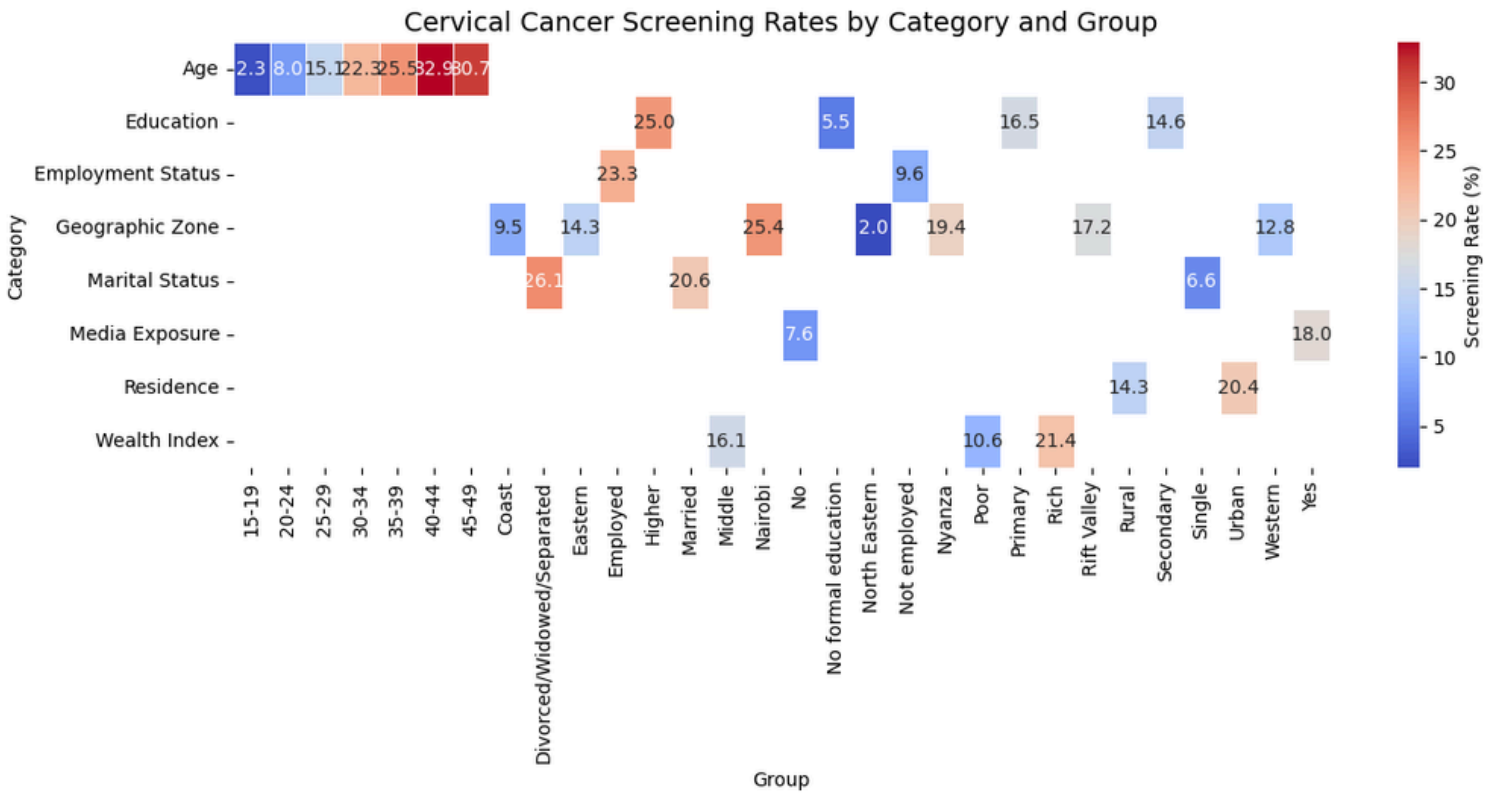

Screening Rate by Wealth Index
Screening Rate (%)
0.0
2.5
5.0
7.5
10.0
12.5
15.0
17.5
20.0
Poor
Middle
Rich
Wealth Category


Screening Rate by Employment Status
Employed
70.9%
29.1%
Not employed


Screening Rate by Media Exposure
Yes
70.3%
29.7%
No


Screening Rate by Residence
Residence Type
Urban
Rural
Rural
41.2%
58.8%
Urban


Screening Rate of Cervical Cancer by Region
Region
Pooled
Nairobi
Western
Rift Valley
Central
Eastern
North Eastern
Coast
0
5
10
15
20
25
Screening Rate (%)


Cervical Cancer Screening Rates by Category and Group
Category
Age
Education
Employment Status
Geographic Zone
Marital Status
Media Exposure
Residence
Wealth Index
2.3
8.0
15.1
22.3
25.5
32.9
30.7
25.0
5.5
16.5
14.6
23.3
9.6
9.5
14.3
25.4
2.0
19.4
17.2
12.8
26.1
20.6
6.6
7.6
18.0
14.3
20.4
16.1
10.6
21.4
15-19
20-24
25-29
30-34
35-39
40-44
45-49
Coast
Divorced/Widowed/Separated
Eastern
Employed
Higher
Married
Middle
Nairobi
No
No formal education
North Eastern
Not employed
Nyanza
Poor
Primary
Rich
Rift Valley
Rural
Secondary
Single
Urban
Western
Yes
Group
Screening Rate (%)
30
25
20
15
10
5